



PHOTO BY HARDIK CHHABRA

THE KOTAK GROUP HAS AMASSED TOTAL ASSETS OF AROUND ₹6.2 LAKH CRORE AND MARKET CAP OF OVER ₹3.5 LAKH CRORE

car finance, investment banking, private equity, and alternative assets. (See box *The Institution Builder*)

Whether it's his knack for being in the right place at the right time after liberalisation or exceptional entrepreneurial

drive, under his leadership the group has generated immense value for stakeholders. If an investor had placed ₹10,000 in the company in 1985 the investment would have skyrocketed to ₹300 crore today. "We have the concept of the

'professional entrepreneur'. The freedom we experience in building new businesses, coupled with the immense ownership we assume, is unparalleled," says K.V.S. Manian, Whole-time Director at the bank. Manian has played a pivotal role in the group's journey from an NBFC to a bank. "Many leaders have built businesses from the ground up, and there's an absence of fear regarding failure. We foster an environment that promotes experimentation and learning, recognising that failures are an integral part of the journey," he adds. That's the culture and legacy Kotak, whose family holds a 26 per cent stake in the bank, has built in the group to continuously challenge the status quo and take risks.

Unfortunately, the RBI's rules on ownership and tenure limits for the post of MD & CEO at private banks impacted Kotak's ambition to hold a larger stake and extend his leadership tenure. Moving ahead, Kotak envisions his role as a non-executive board member, serving as a strategic shareholder with a long-term vision of cultivating a world-class institution. "It's rare in today's global banking landscape to find an individual holding a 26 per cent stake, especially when such a significant portion of family assets is concentrated in a single stock," he wrote in the annual report for FY23.

But Uday Kotak's profile is beyond the Kotak Group. Five

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